Mario Canales

Ph.D. Candidate, UCLA Anderson
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Education

Ph.D. candidate in Economics and Management, UCLA Anderson 2027 (expected)
Committee: Hugo Hopenhayn (co-chair), Nico Voigtlander (co-chair), Romain Wacziarg, Brian Wheaton.
M.Sc. in Economic Analysis, University of Chile 2016
B.A. in Economics, University of Chile 2015

Fields

Primary: Macroeconomics.
Secondary: International Trade, Firm Dynamics.

Job Market Paper

"Link Dynamics and Welfare in Production Networks"

Firms do not buy from the same suppliers forever. Buyer–seller links are formed, sustained, and broken, and that churn reallocates production across the economy. This paper studies how the endogenous formation of production links shapes efficiency and welfare — how much of aggregate performance is determined not by what firms produce, but by whom they choose to trade with.

Presentations: NASMES Atlanta 2026, Central Bank of Chile, Anderson Student Seminar, Proseminar UCLA.

Publications

"Productivity Growth and Workers' Job Transitions: Evidence from Census Microdata"
The Economic Journal, 135(666), 405–429, 2025. Coauthor with E. Albagli, M. Tapia, C. Syverson, and J.M. Wlasiuk.

"Exchange Rates, Uncertainty and Price-setting: Evidence from CPI Microdata"
Economic Modelling, vol. 139, 2024: 106762. Coauthor with B. Lopez-Martin.

Work in Progress

"Firm Dynamics and Wages"

Presentations: Anderson Student Seminar, Central Bank of Chile, SOLE 2023, RES 2024, MEA Chicago 2025, Heriot-Watt University 2025.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, UCLA Anderson:
Managerial Economics (EMBA, FEMBA)
Business and Economics in Emerging Markets (EMBA, FEMBA)

Global Economics and Business Cycles (EMBA, FEMBA)
Global Immersion Course, Chile and Peru (EMBA, FEMBA)
Ethics for Decisionmaking (EMBA, FEMBA)

Research Experience

Research Assistant, **UCLA Anderson** 2023 - 2026
Junior Economist, **Central Bank of Chile** 2016 - 2021
Intern - Consultant, **Inter-American Development Bank** 2016

Fellowships and Grants

Price Center Research Grant, *UCLA Anderson* 2023
Anderson Fellowship, *UCLA Anderson* 2021 - 2026
Fellowship for Graduate Studies, *Central Bank of Chile* 2021-2022
Master Student Scholarship, *University of Chile* 2015 - 2016
Merit-Based First-year Undergraduate Scholarship, *University of Chile* 2010

Pre Doctoral Work

"High Growth Firms and Productivity: Microeconomic evidence for Chile" (in Spanish)
Estudios Públicos, vol. 153: 57-93, 2019. Coauthor with A. García.

"The Effect of Knowledge Obstacles to Innovation in Chilean firms" (in Spanish)
Journal of Technology Management and Innovation, vol. 12(3): 78-85, 2017. Coauthor with R. Álvarez.

"Misallocation or Misspecification? The effect of Average distortions on TFP gains estimations"
Working Paper Central Bank of Chile No. 835, 2019. Coauthor with E. Albagli, A. Martner, M. Tapia, and J.M. Wlasiuk.

"Firm productivity dynamics and distribution: Evidence for Chile using micro data from administrative tax records"
Working Paper Central Bank of Chile No. 831, 2019. Coauthor with E. Albagli, C. de la Huerta, M. Tapia, and J.M. Wlasiuk.

Technical Skills

Languages: English (fluent). Spanish (native).
Softwares: Stata, Matlab, Python, VS Code.
Citizenship: Chilean. *Last Updated: October 16, 2026*